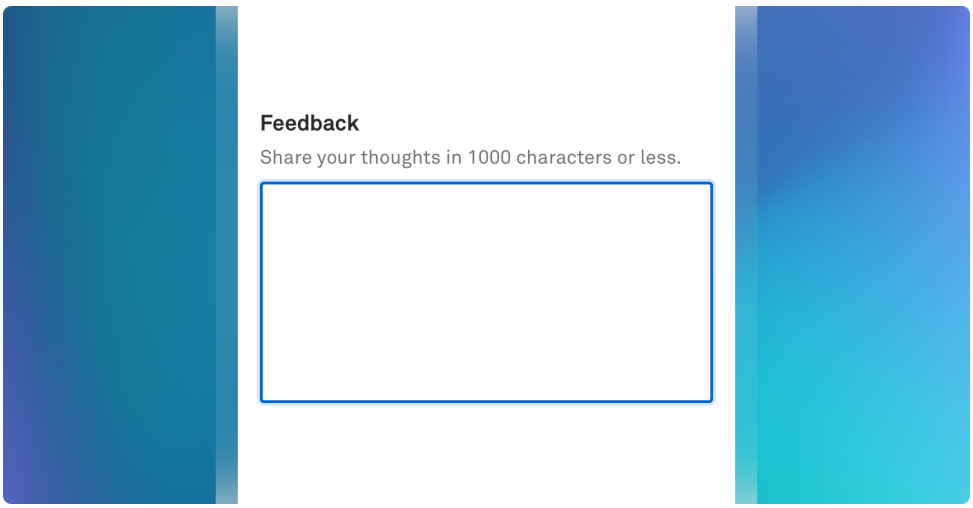
*Need help? Self-Service || Yammer || **No new spaces from Nov-23rd***

Text Area

Created by Hillary Purssey, last modified by Genevieve Wang on 18 Feb 2021



Version

1

Availability

Web

Android

iOS

On This Page

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Text area allows a user to input text that's longer than a single line.

Specs

- Text Area (Web)
- Text Area (Android)
- Text Area (iOS)

UI Playground

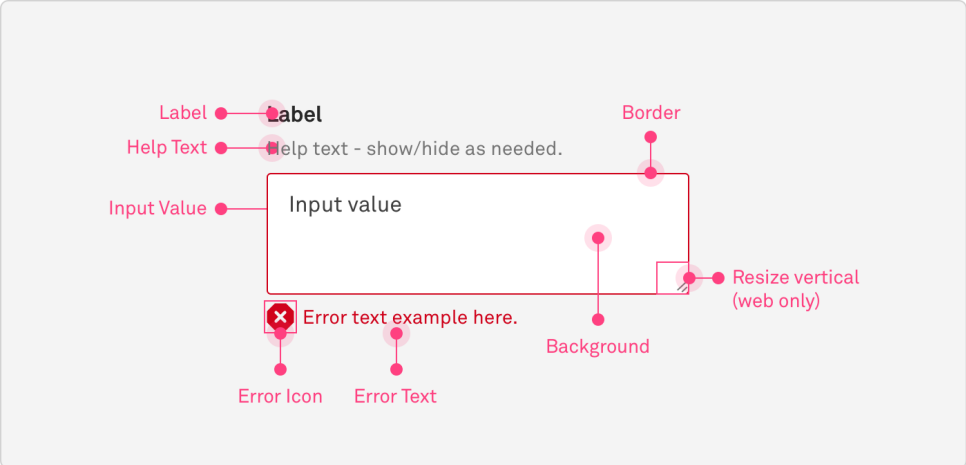
- Web Playground
- React Playground
- Android Catalogue app
- iOS Catalogue app

Usage Guidelines

Text Area can be used to gather text input longer than a single line (e.g. user feedback).

For single line input use Text Field instead.

Anatomy



Text Area States

There are 6 unique states — each communicates the state of the text area as users interact with it.

1. **Default** Normal
2. **Default** Hover (Web only)
3. **Default** Focused
4. **Error** Normal
5. **Error** Hover (Web only)
6. **Error** Focused

Keep in mind:

- '*Focused state*' is triggered by mouse click or keyboard navigation.
- '*Disabled state*' is not supported in Text Area. See why we don't support disable state.

Default States

Label
Help text - show/hide as needed.
Input value
`Default Normal`

Label
Help text - show/hide as needed.
Input value
`Default Hover (Web)`

Label
Help text - show/hide as needed.
Input value
`Default Focused`

Error States

Label
Help text - show/hide as needed.
Input value
Error text example here.
`Error Normal`

Label
Help text - show/hide as needed.
Input value
Error text example here.
`Error Hover (Web)`

Label
Help text - show/hide as needed.
Input value
Error text example here.
`Error Focused`

Best Practices

- **Inform the user of any character limit.**
  Depending on business requirements or technical limitations, a character limit can vary. Recommended limits are 150-200 characters for shorter input (e.g. gift messages), 1000-2000 characters for feedback or reviews.
- **Consider allowing text input to be remembered so users don't have to re-input text.**
  Consider allowing the text input to be remembered to prevent users mistakenly navigating away and having to retype everything again.

Content Guidelines

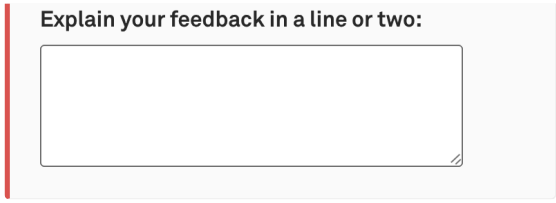
1. Label

Text area labels are visible to users **at all time**. They describe what text information is requested from the users. They should:

- Be succinct and short (1–3 words), avoiding long sentence labels.
- Not be phrased as a question.
- Not end with colon(:) symbol.
- Be written in sentence case.

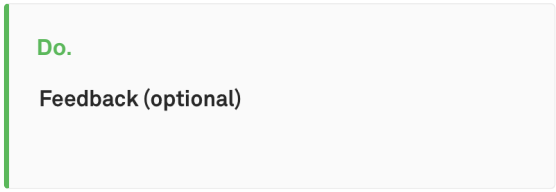
Do.

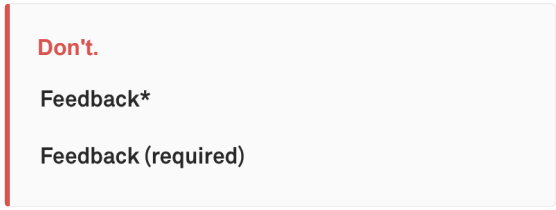
Don't.



How to mark optional fields?

- Mark optional fields by appending "(optional)" at the end of the label.
- Don't mark required fields with asterisks (*), as it adds confusion and not everyone knows what this character means.
- Don't put "This is a required field" in help text. Help text is reserved for input requirements and instructions.





2. Help Text

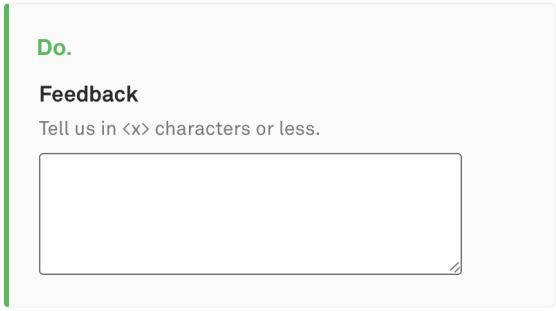
Help text is an optional text displayed below the label, it should only be used for:

1. **Input Guidance** (e.g. describing the input length, required format or structure).
2. **Instructions** on where user can find the required information.

Help text should:

- Be kept short and concise, keeping it to 1 line of text when possible. Long copy will increase user's cognitive load.
- Use sentence case.
- Always end the sentence with a full stop.
- Avoid repeating the label in the help text.

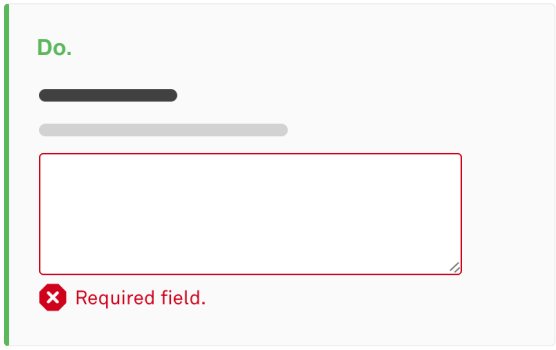
Text areas with a character limit should specify the limit in the help text. This lets us manage a user's expectations as to how much input they can add to the field.

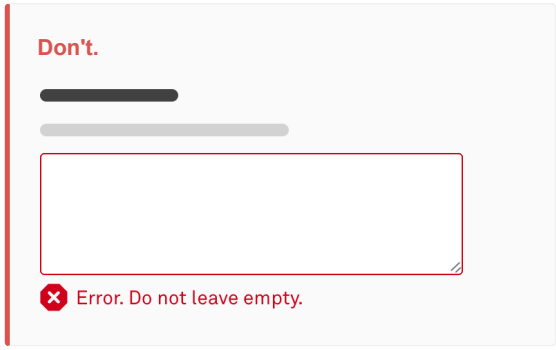


3. Error Text

In a Text Area, an error will be only be shown if it is a required field and the user has left the field blank.

Error text should always be '**Required field.**'.



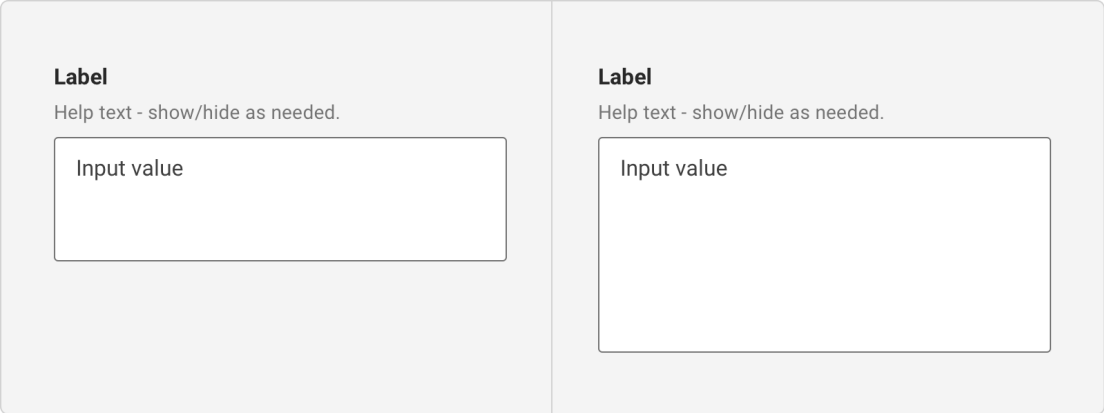


Interactions

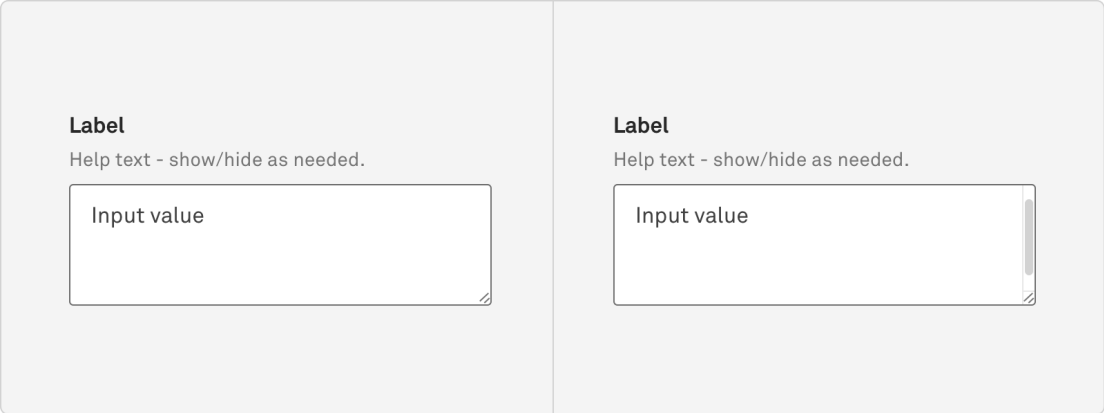
Text Area can be activated with:

- Mouse click on Web
- Single tap on Android/iOS
- Keyboard using TAB key on Web/iOS/Android

The default behaviour of Text Area component on Android & iOS will dynamically expand in height when input has exceeded the default text area height.



On Web, the Text Area will automatically scroll when input has exceeded the default text area height. Users can also manually adjust the height using the resize handle on the bottom right of the text area.



Accessibility Considerations

Text Area is a variation of Text Field. To view the accessibility requirements we meet please refer to the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined within Text Field

Keyboard

Users must be able to navigate to and interact with a Text Area using keyboard alone. A clear visible indicator should also be present when the Text Area has focus.

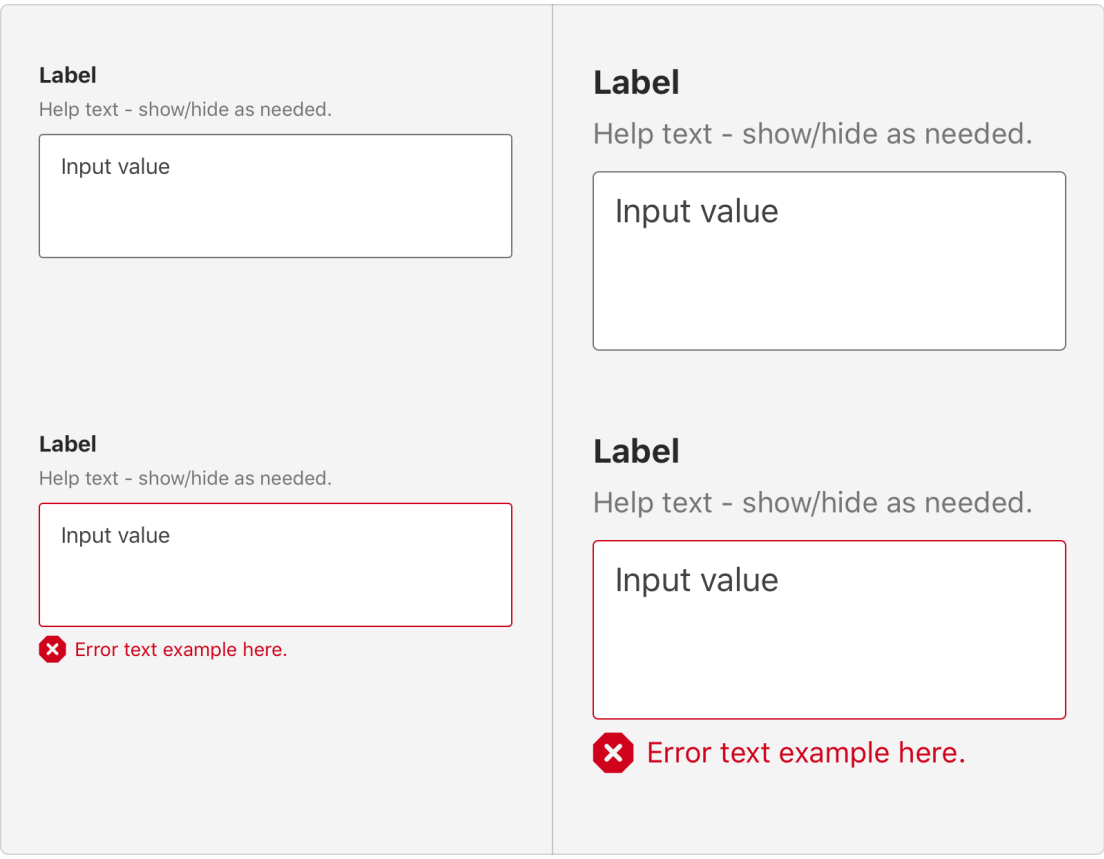
Screen Reader

Screen reader behaviour and the ordering of announcements will vary depending on the platform/browser/screen reader combinations being used.

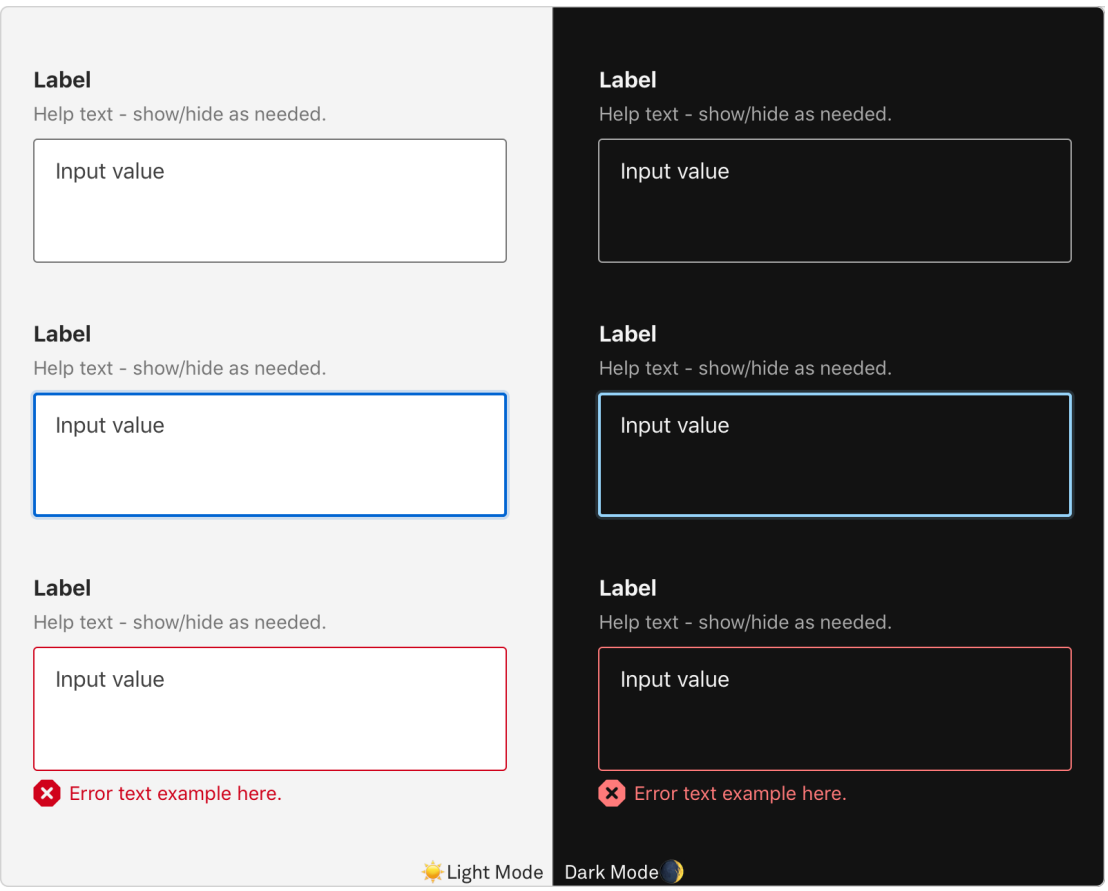
On screen reader focus, announcements may include:

- The **label** of the Text Area
- The **role** such as *multiline textfield* or *editbox*
- Any **help text** that is visible and associated with the Text Area
- Any **user input** in the field
- The **error message** if present
- If the field is **required**
- If the field is **invalid**

Capabilities



Text Area are scaled automatically based on the user's text size preferences.



Text Area will automatically update its appearance based on user's light or dark appearance settings.

Related Patterns

- Text Field
- Text Input Helper

- Search Field *(Coming soon)*
- Password Field *(Coming soon)*
- Date Field *(Coming soon)*

No labels

Atlassian